

The Menu Profitability Audit

Find Your "Time-Thieves" in 15 Minutes

No accounting degree required. Just simple, bakery-floor math.

STEP 1 The Effort Score — How Much Do You Hate Making This?

Be brutally honest. This is the number one hidden cost. Score each item from 1 to 5:

Score	What It Means	Example
1	Mix, shape, bake. Done in 1 hour.	Simple sourdough, brownies
3	Needs overnight proof or a special mould.	Brioche, enriched dough
5	2–3 days of work. Lamination, chilling, multiple rests.	Croissants, Danish pastry

STEP 2 The True Cost — The 3-Bucket Rule

Grab your latest supplier invoices. Fill this out for your top 10 selling items.

Menu Item	A. Ingredients	B. Packaging	C. Labour	TOTAL COST (A+B+C)
<i>Example: Croissant</i>	<i>£1.20</i>	<i>£0.30</i>	<i>£2.50 (45 min)</i>	<i>£4.00</i>
Item 1				
Item 2				
Item 3				
Item 4				
Item 5				
Item 6				
Item 7				
Item 8				
Item 9				
Item 10				

Labour Hack: Time how long it takes to make one batch (e.g. 12 croissants). Divide total time by 12. Multiply by your baker's hourly rate including taxes.

STEP 3 The Real Price vs Real Profit Check

Compare your Total Cost to what you actually charge.

Menu Item	Total Cost (from Step 2)	Your Selling Price	NET PROFIT (Price – Cost)	Profit Margin % (Profit ÷ Price)
Example: Croissant	£4.00	£5.50	£1.50	27%
Item 1				
Item 2				
Item 3				
Item 4				
Item 5				

RED FLAG RULE: If your Net Profit is under £1.00, or your Margin is below 30%, this item is costing you energy you cannot

STEP 4 The Effort vs Profit Matrix — Your Decision Grid

Plot each item into one of these four boxes. This is your menu map.

	HIGH PROFIT (£2+ per unit)	LOW PROFIT (Under £1 per unit)
LOW EFFORT (Score 1–2)	GOLD MINE Promote this. Put it in the window. Make it your hero product.	QUICK FIX Raise the price by 50p today. They will not notice.
HIGH EFFORT (Score 4–5)	PREMIUM Keep it, but charge 20% more. Call it your "Artisanal Signature."	TIME-THIEF Move to Weekly Special or remove from the daily menu.

STEP 5 Your 3-Action Promise — Sign This

Commit to these three actions by end of this week:

1. THE RAISE	I will increase the price of _____ by at least 50p. (Choose a low-profit, low-effort item)
2. THE RETIRE	I will move _____ to a limited weekly special. (Choose a high-effort, low-profit item)
3. THE SPOTLIGHT	I will feature _____ on my social media for 7 days. (Choose a high-profit, low-effort item)

Signed: _____

Date: _____

Ready to price for real profit?

The Baking Business Foundations Certificate takes you from this audit all the way to a complete business plan — with a professional certificate at the end.

thebakingbusinessschool.com

© 2025 The Baking Business School | thebakingbusinessschool.com